

Week 2

Data

How Claude Code sees, processes, and produces your work

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The Atomic Unit



- **Global Inference**

AI trained on the majority of recorded human knowledge. The electron — always orbiting, always available.

- **Encoded Local Context**

Your firm's knowledge, organized for AI to navigate. What the model can't already have.

- **Computational Environment**

The ability to act, not just think. To produce a model, not describe one.

- **Real-Time Human Intelligence**

Judgment that can't be encoded. The human is a permanent component.

The interaction produces something none of them contain individually.

Claude Code Is the Layer

Accesses

Structured, unstructured, and code — all at once

Processes

Reasons, analyzes, transforms, connects

Produces

Documents, models, dashboards, deliverables

Claude Code is where inference meets environment.

You wrap your workflow inside of it. Not the other way around.

Your IP Lives in Markdown

Encoded Local Context in practice



CLAUDE.md

The operating instructions

How the firm works. What roles exist. How to format output. What data connects to what.

Claude Code reads this first, every time.



_reference/

The institutional knowledge

Methodologies, templates, frameworks, voice guides. The field guide for a capable new colleague.

What the model can't already have.

These files are your competitive advantage. Generic data produces generic output.

Three Types of Data



Structured

CSV, JSON, databases,
spreadsheets, APIs



Unstructured

PDFs, memos, emails,
reports, questionnaires

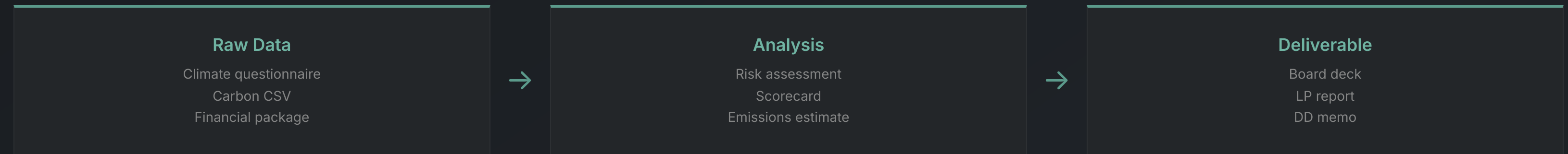


Code

Scripts, configs,
templates, markdown

Claude Code treats all three as equal. No connectors. No ETL. Just reading.

Inputs → Outputs → Inputs



↪ Every output becomes the input for the next task

Four Categories



Data Sources

Where information lives

Files, APIs, databases, web pages



MCPs

Universal adapters to services

Figma, Supabase, GitHub, Slack



Compute Tools

Extend what CC can do

Playwright for browser, bash for system



Output Tools

Produce deliverables

PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint

Your Toolkit

Playwright	Browser automation — navigate sites, scrape data, take screenshots, fill forms
Desktop Commander	System-level control — file management, screenshots, window management
Claude Code Skills	Built-in document generation — PDF, Excel, Word, PowerPoint
Bash / Terminal	Run scripts, process files, call APIs directly

Start with what your task requires. You don't need all of these.

MCPs and APIs

MCP

A universal hallway.

One protocol connects you to many services. Same interface, different destinations. Claude Code navigates it for you.

API

A door to one specific service.

You knock, ask for something specific, get a response. Each door has its own key and its own protocol.

From your perspective: APIs require you to know the address. MCPs let Claude Code find it.

Output Types

Documents .pdf .docx .pptx	Data Files .xlsx .csv .json .tsv	Analysis Scorecards, risk assessments, benchmarks
Code .py .js .sh .html .css	Visualizations .svg .png charts, dashboards	Structured Knowledge .md reference docs, frameworks

You Are the Consultant

- Northwood Capital hired your team
- The data is messy, incomplete, contradictory
- *Like real client data*
- Your deliverables don't exist yet
- *Last week's pitch deck? That was the easy part.*

This week you build the analytical foundation.

This Week's Deliverables

1 Identify what data exists

Inventory the environment. What did Northwood give you?

2 Assess its quality

Completeness, consistency, reliability. Where do you trust it?

3 Determine fixes for data errors

Contradictions, unit mismatches, outliers. What's the correction?

4 Identify missing data

Gaps that block analysis. What do you need that isn't there?

5 Create your data ask

A structured request back to the client for what's missing.

Build to Learn

The skill isn't prompting.

It's directing inference.

Start with the data. Let Claude Code show you what's there.

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